🎨 Renaissance: Reading

World History · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · our own reading

Name: _____

Words to know: ***patron*** *= a rich supporter who pays an artist ·* ***sculptor*** *= an artist who carves statues*



Leonardo da Vinci, self-portrait (red chalk)



Michelangelo: Sistine Chapel ceiling

Leonardo and Michelangelo

Leonardo da Vinci was born in 1452 near Florence, Italy. As a teenager he learned to paint in the workshop of the artist Verrocchio. He was curious about everything: plants, water, birds and the human body.

Leonardo painted **The Last Supper** on a wall in Milan and the **Mona Lisa**, a portrait of Lisa del Giocondo. He blended colors softly, with no hard lines. This is called **sfumato**.

Leonardo's notebooks hold more than 7,000 surviving pages. He sketched flying machines (he thought they should copy a bat's wings), an armored tank and weapons, and drew some of the most accurate pictures of human anatomy of his time. He wrote in mirror writing, from right to left.

Leonardo worked for many patrons: the Duke of Milan, the city of Florence and, at the end of his life, King Francis I of France.

Michelangelo Buonarroti was born in 1475. As a teenager he studied in Florence and lived in the household of Lorenzo de' Medici, the city's most powerful patron. He saw himself as a sculptor first. His **Pietà** (Mary holding Jesus) made him famous at about 24, and his marble **David**, about 17 feet tall, became a symbol of Florence.

Pope Julius II hired Michelangelo to paint the **Sistine Chapel** ceiling, a huge **fresco**. The two argued about money and time, but Michelangelo finished in 1512. Later he painted The Last Judgment and designed the dome of St. Peter's Basilica.

Both men studied the human body closely, worked for powerful patrons and were shaped by the Church and by classical ideas. Because they mastered art, science and engineering, both are called **Renaissance men**.

Check your reading

1. Where and how did each artist learn art?

2. Name two patrons of each artist.

3. Explain one way the Church AND one way classical ideas shaped their art.